DUBAI PODCAST STUDIO — EQUIPMENT SPECIFICATION

Video-First Studio Upgrade.

Exact cameras, exact lighting, exact settings, exact costs in AED. Where to buy in Dubai. How to set up each room. What to charge clients. Everything needed to go from audio studio to broadcast-ready video studio.

PHASE 1 — 3 ROOMS
AED 14,850

FULL 7 ROOMS
AED 34,650

TIME TO SET UP
1 day per room

ROI BREAK-EVEN
~12 video sessions per room

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00 — THE APPROACH

Don't Upgrade All 7 at Once

Phase the investment. Start with 3 flagship video studios, market them aggressively, measure demand, then expand. This protects cash flow and lets you refine the setup before committing to all 7 rooms.

PHASE 1 — NOW

Flagship Launch

3 studios upgraded

AED 14,850

total · ~AED 4,950/studio

PHASE 2 — MONTH 3

Scale if Demand Confirms

+2 studios (total 5)

AED 9,900

PHASE 3 — MONTH 6

Full Conversion

Final 2 studios

AED 9,900

final investment · all 7 done

	additional investment	

WHY 3 FIRST

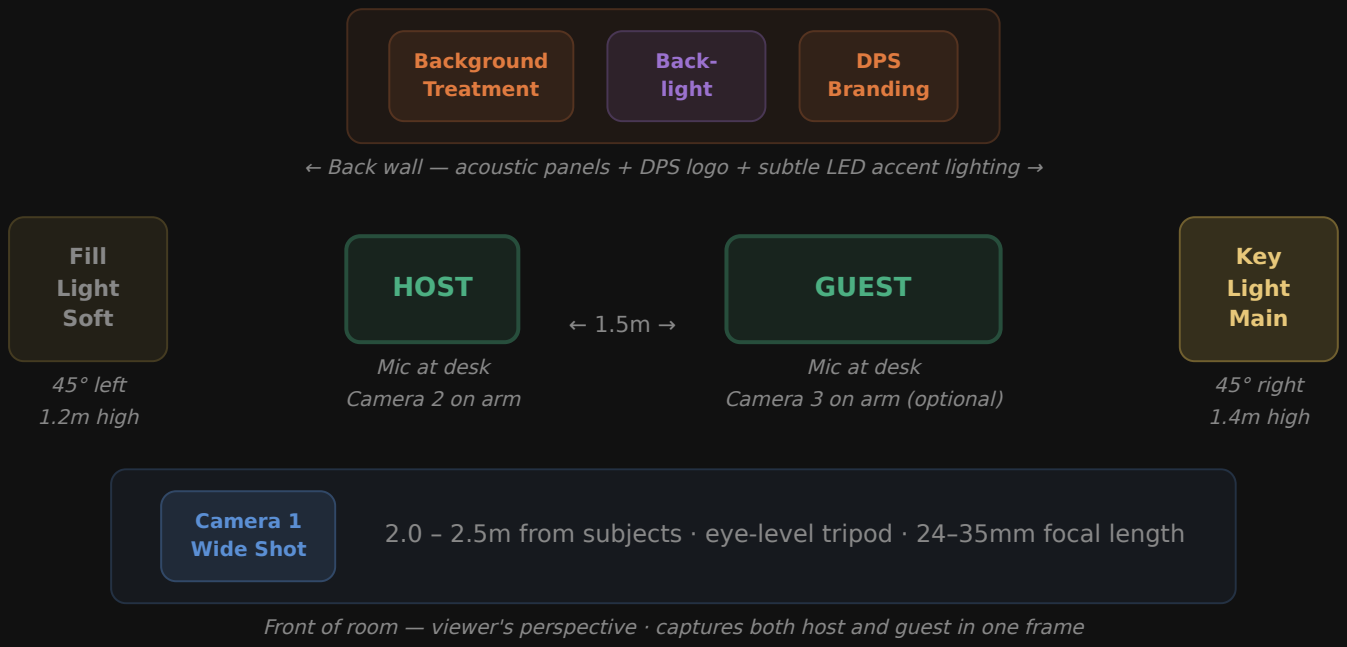
Video podcast bookings will initially come from your most engaged, most visible existing clients — those who already have audiences and understand the value. 3 studios is more than enough capacity to handle that initial demand while you build the marketing machine. Once those 3 rooms are generating observable video premium revenue, the case for rooms 4–7 is self-funding and obvious.

01 — THE SETUP

Exact Room Layout per Studio

This is the standard DPS video configuration. Every video-capable studio should follow this layout exactly, so all DPS video content has a consistent look — a recognisable visual brand.

STUDIO VIDEO LAYOUT — TOP-DOWN VIEW (3M × 4M ROOM MINIMUM)



02 — CAMERAS

Camera Specification

You need 1 wide camera per studio as minimum viable setup. Add a second close-up camera per seat if budget allows — it enables proper multi-camera editing and a more professional final cut.

Primary Camera — Wide Shot

1 per studio minimum

BUDGET PATH

Sony ZV-E10 II

MOST POPULAR

ILCZV-E10M / Kit with 16-50mm lens

APS-C sensor. 4K 30fps video. Clean HDMI output (critical — not all cameras have this). Excellent autofocus locks onto faces automatically — no camera operator needed during a session. Lightweight, mounts on desk arm.

AED 1,399

Sharaf DG · Jumbo Electronics · Amazon.ae

Best value for podcast video. The autofocus means your engineer doesn't have to touch it during a 60-minute session.

RECOMMENDED

Sony FX30

DPS STANDARD

ILME-FX30 + 15mm PZ lens

Super 35 cinema sensor — same sensor as professional cinema cameras. 4K 120fps. Built-in ND filter (critical in studio with mixed lighting). Full-size HDMI. Designed specifically for video production. Looks unmistakably professional.

AED 3,199

Sharaf DG · Virgin Megastore Dubai Mall · Sony Centre

Cinema-quality image that justifies a premium price tier. When clients see their footage, they won't want to record anywhere else.

Close-Up Camera — Per Seat

optional, 1 per person

BUDGET

Sony ZV-1 II

ZV-1M2 compact camera

Compact, mounts on a flexible arm clipped to the desk. Clean HDMI out. Ultra-wide 18mm lens — ideal for tight desk-mounted shot. Used by hundreds of professional podcast studios globally as the "per-seat" close-up camera.

AED 1,799

Sharaf DG · Amazon.ae

Positioned 40–50cm from the subject's face. Captures the expression details that make video podcasts compelling.

RECOMMENDED

Sony a7C II

ILCE-7CM2 full-frame + 24mm

Full-frame sensor — produces the cinematic shallow depth of field (blurred background) that signals premium production. 4K 60fps. Best-in-class skin tones. Used by Joe Rogan's production team and major network podcast shows for close-up talent shots.

AED 4,499

Sony Centre Dubai · Sharaf DG

Full-frame background blur is immediately recognisable as professional quality. This is what makes the difference between "looks like a podcast" and "looks like Netflix."

THE MOST IMPORTANT CAMERA SETTING — ALWAYS HDMI CLEAN OUTPUT

Every camera you purchase must have **clean HDMI output** — meaning the HDMI port sends pure video signal with no on-screen menus, battery indicators, or overlays. Not all cameras have this. The Sony models specified above all do. Before purchasing any other camera brand, specifically verify "clean HDMI output" in the spec sheet. Without it, you cannot record the video feed to an external recorder or capture card.

03 — LIGHTING

Lighting Specification

Lighting is more important than the camera. An average camera with excellent lighting looks more professional than an excellent camera with average lighting. This is where most studios underinvest.

Key Light — Main Illumination

1 per studio, required

BUDGET

Godox SL60W + Softbox

`SL60W + 60×90cm softbox kit`

60W LED panel with large softbox diffuser. Bi-colour 2800–6500K. Remote controllable. Produces soft, flattering light on faces — not harsh shadows. Industry-standard for YouTube and podcast studios. Very reliable, widely used in Dubai studios.

AED 450

Sharaf DG · Studio One FZ LLC · Amazon.ae

Best value key light available. Professional studios globally use this exact model. No reason to spend more unless upgrading to RGB.

RECOMMENDED

Aputure Amaran 200d S + Softbox

BEST RESULT

`Amaran 200d S + 90×90cm Lantern`

200W daylight LED — significantly brighter, more light control, higher quality diffusion. Produces the clinical, broadcast-quality look seen on major podcast shows. App-controlled, DMX compatible. Aputure is the industry standard for professional video lighting globally.

AED 1,250

Aputure UAE dealer · B&H (ships to UAE) · Amazon.ae

This light is the one that makes a client say "wow, this looks like proper TV." Justifies the price premium for video sessions.

Fill Light + Backlight

2 more lights per studio

FILL LIGHT

Godox SL60W (second unit)

`Same model, opposite side, 50% power`

The fill light is the same model as the key — placed on the opposite side at half power. This fills shadows on the face without eliminating them. Rule: fill light

BACKLIGHT / HAIR LIGHT

Neewer RGB LED Panel

`Neewer 660 PRO RGB — compact panel`

Small, bright LED panel positioned behind and above the subject. Creates a subtle rim of light that separates the subject from the background — the

always 50% brightness of key light. Use same softbox for even diffusion. Total for key + fill: AED 900.

AED 450 (second unit)

Same sources as key light

Without a fill light, one side of every face is in shadow. This is the most common mistake in podcast video setups — fixed with one extra light.

professional "glow" visible in all high-end studio productions. Also functions as background accent lighting. RGB: match DPS brand colours.

AED 220

Amazon.ae · Sharaf DG

Without a backlight, subjects "merge" into the background visually. This AED 220 light is the difference between flat and three-dimensional.

COLOUR TEMPERATURE

5600K

All lights at 5600K (daylight). Never mix warm and cool in the same shot. Set camera white balance to match: 5600K manual.

KEY LIGHT POWER

100%

Key light at full power. Fill light at 50%. Backlight at 30–40%. This ratio creates natural, three-dimensional shadow structure.

KEY LIGHT ANGLE

45° / 45°

Rembrandt positioning: 45° to the side, 45° above eye level. Universally flattering, standard in professional portrait and interview production.

04 — CAPTURE & CONNECTION

Getting Video Into Your Computer

The camera records to its SD card simultaneously while feeding live video via HDMI to a capture card connected to the studio Mac or PC. The capture card converts HDMI to USB-C input.

CAPTURE CARD REQUIRED

Elgato Cam Link 4K

10GAM9901

Plug-and-play HDMI → USB-C. Camera appears as a webcam source in OBS, Zoom, Ecamm, Riverside. 4K 30fps or 1080p 60fps passthrough. Works immediately on Mac and PC — no driver installation, no configuration. One per camera feed.

AED 549

Sharaf DG · Amazon.ae · Virgin Megastore

The simplest, most reliable solution. Used by tens of thousands of professional studios globally. If it fails, replacement arrives next day from Amazon.ae.

MULTI-CAMERA SWITCHER

Blackmagic ATEM Mini Pro

ATEM Mini Pro ISO

Handles 4 HDMI camera inputs simultaneously. Hardware multi-cam switching — the engineer can cut between cameras live during a session. Records all 4 cameras to USB simultaneously. Makes post-production significantly faster — no syncing needed. A serious upgrade for 2+ camera setups.

AED 1,299

Sharaf DG · Geekay Games · Amazon.ae

For a 2+ camera studio, this removes the single most time-consuming part of post-production: multi-cam sync and assembly. Pays for itself within 5 sessions of engineer time saved.



05 — SOFTWARE

Post-Production Software Stack

DaVinci Resolve

AED 0 (free)

Edit · Colour Grade · Audio Sync · Export

The industry-standard professional video editing suite. Used by Netflix, HBO, and Hollywood productions. Multi-cam editing with automatic sync from audio waveform — aligns all cameras in one click. Colour grading built in. Free version handles everything a podcast studio needs. Resolve Studio (paid) adds noise reduction and some AI tools.

OBS Studio

AED 0 (free)

Live Recording · Multi-Camera · Live Streaming

Free, open-source recording and streaming software. Captures all camera feeds simultaneously. Can live-stream to YouTube, LinkedIn, and Instagram simultaneously while recording local files. If DPS wants to offer live podcast recording as a service, OBS is the engine. Used by every major live podcast and streaming studio globally.

Ecamm Live

AED 550/year

Professional Live Recording · Mac Only · Multi-Guest

The most polished, professionally oriented live recording tool for Mac. Handles remote guests via Zoom/Riverside with automatic scene switching. Lower-thirds graphics, PiP layouts, and real-time transitions — all without editing. Used by premium podcast studios when the client wants a same-day broadcast or live episode. Subscription: AED 55/month or AED 550/year.

Opus Clip (already in use)

Already subscribed

AI Reels — Auto-clip generation from full episode

Already part of the DPS stack. Once video recording is in place, Opus Clip value multiplies — it now has video to work with, not just audio. Generates 5–10 vertical Reels from every episode automatically. The "DPS Content Engine" runs on this.

06 — EXACT COSTS

Cost Per Studio — Three Budget Levels

ITEM	BUDGET SETUP	RECOMMENDED SETUP	PREMIUM SETUP
Primary Camera (wide shot) + lens + tripod	AED 1,399 Sony ZV-E10 II	AED 3,199 Sony FX30	AED 6,499 BMPCC 6K G2
Close-Up Camera per talent seat, desk arm mount	— 1 camera only	AED 1,799 Sony ZV-1 II	AED 4,499 Sony a7C II
Key Light + Softbox main illumination, 45° position	AED 450 Godox SL60W	AED 1,250 Aputure Amaran 200d S	AED 2,100 Aputure 300c
Fill Light + Softbox opposite side, 50% power	AED 450 Godox SL60W	AED 450 Godox SL60W	AED 450 Godox SL60W
Backlight / Hair Light behind subject, rim separation	AED 220 Neewer RGB Panel	AED 220 Neewer RGB Panel	AED 550 Godox RGB SL60
Capture Card / Switcher HDMI → Mac/PC	AED 549 Elgato Cam Link 4K	AED 1,299 ATEM Mini Pro ISO	AED 1,299 ATEM Mini Pro ISO
Cables, Mounts, Arms HDMI cables, desk arms, light stands	AED 280	AED 380	AED 500
TOTAL PER STUDIO	**AED 3,348**	**AED 8,597**	**AED 15,897**

THE RECOMMENDATION FOR DPS PHASE 1

Use the **Recommended Setup (AED 8,597/studio)** for your 3 flagship video rooms. The budget setup looks visibly cheaper on screen — clients will notice. The premium setup is unnecessary for podcasting. At AED 8,597, each studio generates ROI from approximately **12 video sessions charged at AED 700 premium** over the base audio rate. At realistic demand, break-even arrives within 6–8 weeks of launch.

07 — CAMERA SETTINGS

Exact Camera Settings — Sony FX30

Save these as a custom preset on the camera. Every session starts with these settings locked. No engineer should be adjusting settings mid-session.

RESOLUTION

4K / 25fps

4K for future-proofing. 25fps for UAE market (PAL standard). Never

SHUTTER SPEED

1/50s

Always 2× the frame rate. At 25fps: 1/50s shutter. This is the 180-

ISO

800–1600

Studio lighting means low ISO is achievable. Keep below 3200 to

use 60fps for podcast — too smooth, removes cinematic feel.

degree rule — produces natural motion blur on any movement.

avoid noise. With Aputure Amaran at full power: ISO 800 is achievable.

WHITE BALANCE

5600K Manual

Never use Auto White Balance — it drifts during a session. Set manually to match your lights: 5600K if using daylight LEDs.

PICTURE PROFILE

S-Cinetone

Sony's built-in cinematic colour profile. Warm, flattering skin tones, natural contrast. No colour grading knowledge needed — looks professional straight out of camera.

AUTOFOCUS

Real-Time Eye AF

Sony's eye-tracking AF locks onto the host's eye and never loses focus. The engineer never needs to touch the focus during a 90-minute session. Set to Human → Eye AF.

08 — NEW PRICING

What to Charge for Video Sessions

EXISTING SERVICE

Audio-Only Session

Base rate

unchanged

No change to existing pricing. Audio clients continue as normal. Video is an upgrade, not a replacement.

NEW — VIDEO PREMIUM

Video Podcast Session

+AED 500–700

on top of base audio rate

Session in video-equipped studio. Full video + audio recording. 2 camera angles. Basic colour correction. Delivered as sync'd audio+video file within 24 hours.

NEW — FULL PACKAGE

Video + Content Engine

+AED 950–1,200

on top of base audio rate

Everything in Video Premium + AI Reels (5 vertical clips) + transcript + show notes + thumbnail design. Complete deliverable package — ready to publish everywhere.

WHAT A SESSION DELIVERED TO LOOK LIKE BEFORE

- ✗ Audio file only (.wav or .mp3)
- ✗ Client edits themselves or pays external editor
- ✗ No video — can't publish to YouTube
- ✗ No social content — must create separately
- ✗ No transcript — must use external tool

WHAT A SESSION DELIVERS AFTER THIS UPGRADE

- ✓ Broadcast-quality audio file (as before)
- ✓ 4K multi-camera video — ready for YouTube
- ✓ 5 vertical Reels — ready for IG/TikTok/LinkedIn
- ✓ Full transcript + show notes — ready to publish
- ✓ Branded thumbnail — professional, consistent